



Liquid fuels demand and supply model

Manish hand-back

7 October | Baseline, fuel input tables and decision log

6 October 2026

Internal working discussion

Photo source: Royal Vopak | Terminal Durban | vopak.com

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On customs trade, 2024 petrol and diesel sales exceed net imports by 7.7 bn litres

Corrected balance | calendar years, billion litres | imports and exports from SARS customs

Year	Petrol				Diesel			
	Sales	Imports	Exports	Sales less net imports	Sales	Imports	Exports	Sales less net imports
2019	10.77	1.48	1.17	10.47	12.91	5.59	1.74	9.06
2020	8.76	1.72	1.15	8.20	11.69	6.81	0.91	5.79
2021	9.30	4.01	1.05	6.35	12.95	9.76	0.89	4.08
2022	9.18	5.46	0.85	4.58	12.72	11.95	0.89	1.65
2023	9.04	4.48	0.99	5.55	12.91	12.87	0.89	0.93
2024	9.03	4.00	0.92	5.95	11.73	10.79	0.80	1.74
2025	—	4.45	0.80	—	—	12.25	0.75	—

Sales less net imports is what production, stock changes and gaps in sales coverage must together supply. It is not a measurement of production.

Sales: department to 2023; 2024 is FIASA's figure and is unverified; none yet for 2025. Rebuilt by one command from registered inputs; a test checks every year against the customs extract.

Sources agree on most years; five differences need a recorded choice

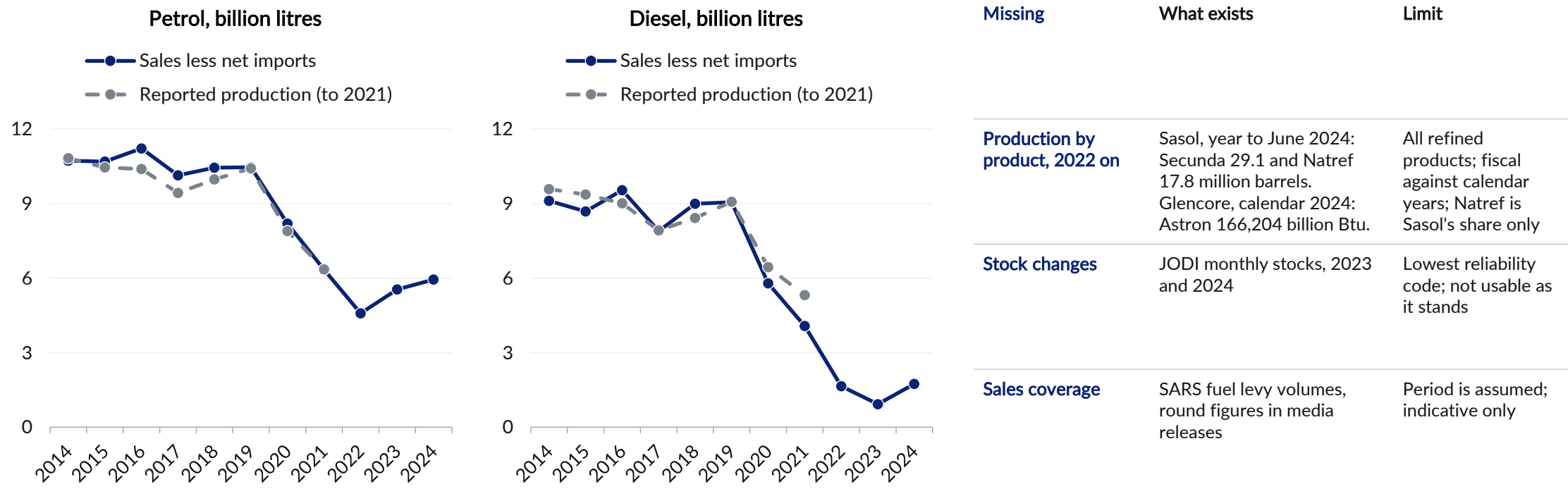
Source differences | billion litres | every source is kept in its own column of the balance file

Item	What the sources say	Used in the balance	Who decides
2024 sales	FIASA 2025 edition, p.47: petrol 9.03, diesel 11.73. FIASA 2024 edition, p.32: 8.76 and 11.81. JODI: 10.14 and 10.04 (lowest reliability code). Department: not published.	FIASA 2025 edition, flagged unverified	Nigel: agree the 2024 sales source
2024 diesel imports	Customs 10.793. Department trade report 10.8 (rounded). FIASA 14.793, a suspected misprint.	Customs	Nigel: review
2018 and 2019 trade	2018 diesel: customs 5.12, FIASA 6.11; petrol: 1.83 and 2.19. 2019 diesel: 5.59 and 5.86. 2018 exports are also lower in customs. Cause not found.	Customs	Nigel: review; Manish to trace
2022 diesel exports	Customs 0.89, FIASA 0.70.	Customs	Nigel: review
2019 and 2020 energy balances	Their import and export lines repeat the previous year's figures.	Not used for trade	Nigel: confirm

In the other years from 2014, customs and FIASA differ by 0.2 bn litres or less; the full list is in the balance note. Before 2014 customs is in kilograms or mixed units, so FIASA is used.

Production after 2021 and stock changes are missing, so the balance is not closed

Missing production and stocks | sales less net imports against production reported in the energy balance



A diesel gap of 3 to 4 bn litres a year remains a hypothesis to test. It is not added to demand. Needed to close: output by product and plant, a stock series, and matched periods.

Presentation palette | colours and HEX codes

Reference | colours used in this presentation

Core presentation colours

	Vopak blue #0A2373		Secondary blue #546CA2		Text / ink #000000		White #FFFFFF
	Unassessed / neutral #EEEEEE		Header divider #A0A0A0		Body divider #B8B8B8		Frame divider #B0B0B0

Sales-map colours | provincial totals, bn litres/year

	Below 1 #E3EBF6		1 to below 2 #BACCE4		2 to below 4 #809CC7		4 to below 6 #3D619D
	6 and above #0A2373		Map background #F5F8FB				

Other template theme colours

	Theme dark 2 #11151A		Theme light 2 #E7E6E6		Accent 3 #BDBEC1		Accent 4 #404040
	Accent 5 #767676		Accent 6 #D9D9D9				

Typeface: Lato. Sales colours show totals, not density or market share. Grey denotes unassessed demand.

Source: supplied Vopak template; pptx/brand_configs/vopak.py; provincial_demand_map.py.

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